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Regenerative Reciprocity

The Relational and Economic Architecture of a Living Commons

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Abstract

This report describes how Spiralweb proposes to organise economic flow through its network of AnchorPoints. The argument is simple to state and demanding to enact. Regenerative work needs material support, and material support needs a form that does not corrupt what it touches. Many regenerative initiatives do not fail for lack of care or competence; they fail, or remain fragile, because the financial form around them is structurally misaligned with the work. They are funded as projects, compete for short cycles of philanthropic capital, adapt their language to funder priorities, and dry out when the cycle ends.

Regenerative Reciprocity is the economic architecture proposed in answer. It is not a fund. It is not a grant programme. It is not an investment vehicle. It is a polycentric flow architecture grounded in real people and places, structured by PG Ledger observation, separated into three structurally distinct streams (Land and Ecology, Steward Viability, Governance and Collaboration), and calibrated by phase. Support enters where the field can hold it. Fragility is protected. Where abundance eventually emerges, capacity circulates back to shared infrastructure and outward to other fields rather than terminating as private extraction.

This report does not claim to have solved the problems it names. It claims that an honest economic form has been specified far enough for bounded testing and correction, and that it is worth attempting. It does not ask regenerative fields to become profitable units in a new green economy. It asks whether real people, in real places, can enter a documented relationship of stewardship in which support strengthens life, evidence protects truth, and abundance, when it appears, does not stop at the first successful node.

Function of this treaty

This treaty carries the slow-changing relational, constitutional, and economic proposition of Regenerative Reciprocity: what an AnchorPoint is, why regenerative work dries out, how the three streams and five PG Ledger formats make support legible, when reciprocity may activate, and which conditions prevent the architecture from becoming extractive.

The operational expression of this architecture — budgets, worked examples, phase protocols, the 90-day cycle, risk controls, legal classification, banking, agreements, country annexes, and organisational workload — is set out in *Regenerative Reciprocity — Operational Handbook*, prepared as a separate companion document.

The treaty and handbook are designed as a public document pair. The Operational Handbook has been prepared separately but is not yet published. References to its numbered sections are retained for traceability and will become direct links when the handbook is released. The treaty governs purpose, interpretation, and the conditions that prevent capture. The handbook governs procedure and may be revised more frequently as field experience, legal review, banking conditions, and organisational capacity develop. A separate Internal Governance Annex supports board decisions and is not part of the public architecture.

Document family and function

Report 06 sits within a wider Spiralweb document family. It does not stand alone, and it is not asked to carry the entire architecture of the work. Locating it accurately matters, because it determines what readers should and should not expect from this single report.

The current public architecture is held across several differentiated records. **The Protocol Habitat** distinguishes Foundations, Protocols, Applications, and Tools and explains how generic material becomes answerable to a real place. **Constitutional Ground** holds the association's institutional orientation. **Support, Funding, and Patron Pathways** describes how support may enter without purchasing authority, ownership, or hidden control. The public field pages and AnchorPoints hold current relational status. The operational handbook and internal governance annex, where referenced below, remain separate procedural records and are not themselves proof that any field cycle is active.

Report 06 has a narrower and more specific function. It describes the economic flow architecture of Spiralweb: how selected support may enter place-bound relationships, how PG Ledger can hold financial and non-financial memory, how the three streams remain non-compensatory, and how reciprocity may activate only when real abundance exists.

This report does not create an AnchorPoint, authorise a place-bound application, activate a field cycle, or make a tool into a protocol. It describes financial and relational conditions under which selected support flows may be received, documented, allocated, governed, and — when conditions allow — circulated. The current status and authority of any field must be established through the relevant place-bound records, not inferred from this report.

Operational summary

Regenerative Reciprocity is Spiralweb's proposed financial architecture for supporting AnchorPoints without turning them into projects, beneficiaries, investment assets, or donor-controlled sites.

The model rests on five operational commitments. Support enters through documented AnchorPoints, not through abstract programmes. All flows are separated into three streams: Land and Ecology, Steward Viability, and Governance and Collaboration. Money is registered through PG Ledger Format 5, linking each transfer to purpose, stream, legal classification, and observed field effect. No reciprocity is expected from fragile fields — red and yellow phases protect the field, and only stable green and deep green fields may begin modest outward circulation. The architecture is legally bounded: it begins as an internal restricted pool within the association, not as a separate fund, investment vehicle, or informal money-circulation system.

The purpose is not to scale a funding programme quickly. The purpose is to test whether financial support can strengthen living fields without capture, extraction, or hidden human depletion.

Genealogy — where this report stands

This report stands within several converging lineages. From Elinor and Vincent Ostrom's polycentric governance theory, it inherits the principles that inform the wider Spiralweb architecture: clearly defined boundaries, locally-shaped rules, participation by those affected, monitoring by those closest to the field, graduated responses, accessible conflict resolution, nested governance, and the unconditional withdrawal right. From the Moral Biology framework developed in Series I of the Green Papers, it inherits the conviction that ethics is a capacity grounded in nervous systems, relations, and conditions — and that economic forms that deplete bodies, relations, or conditions cannot be regenerative regardless of what they produce. From Penguin Economics (Green Paper 12), it inherits the rotation logic that makes the reciprocity bands legible: in an exposed system, capacity moves toward the cold edge, fragile fields are protected, and surplus circulates rather than accumulating at one node. From SRIP (Report 05), it inherits bounded entry with a real place, the three-stream separation, the burden test, the right to pause or withdraw, and the decisive question. Ten square metres and a Circle of 13 remain possible forms, not universal scales or conditions of entry.

The architecture also follows a biomimetic premise: resilience emerges from diversity, distributed sensing, rotation, and circulation rather than from central command. This principle is operational, not metaphorical. It shapes how flow moves between AnchorPoints, how risk is distributed, and how the centre is kept light enough not to absorb the work the field is doing.

Regenerative Reciprocity also belongs to a wider shift from extractive society to flow society — not boundaryless circulation, but life-supporting flow through clear membranes. The streams, the phase reading, the Red Phase Protocol, and the non-compensatory rule are all expressions of this principle: flow is good only when membranes are honest.

The legal container: Planetary Guardians, SpiralWeb, and the Association

One distinction must be clear before the financial architecture can be read accurately, because money requires a legal holder.

Planetary Guardians names the broader field protocol and network. **SpiralWeb** names the coordination infrastructure and knowledge commons. **Spiralweb Stewardship Association** is the legal and institutional container through which selected support flows may be received, documented, allocated, and governed. The association does not own the whole field; it holds selected flows responsibly.

This distinction matters for several reasons. It tells a bank, an auditor, or a foundation exactly which entity is the legal counterparty. It tells a steward at an AnchorPoint that the wider Planetary Guardians work continues to belong to the field, not to the association. It tells a patron that supporting the association does not equate to acquiring rights over the wider network. And it tells a board member which decisions belong to the association's governance and which belong elsewhere in the architecture. Throughout the rest of this report, references to "the association" mean the Spiralweb Stewardship Association in its specific legal and institutional capacity. References to AnchorPoints, the network, the field, or Planetary Guardians refer to the wider relational and protocol architecture in which the association sits.

The integrative contribution of this report

What this report contributes is not new doctrine. The five PG Ledger formats are now documented and available. The three streams already exist. The non-compensatory rule already exists. The Constitutional Ground document already addresses non-capture support. The Support, Funding, and Patron Pathways kernel document already names the basic relationship between supporter and field. This report's contribution is integrative: it specifies the financial form within which these existing architectures can hold money without distortion. It integrates the fifth PG Ledger format (Financial), which registers what the first four cannot. It calibrates the reciprocity bands. It sets out the legal and operational conditions under which cross-border flows can be both bankable and non-extractive. It names the organisational capacity required to carry the work honestly.

The report does not assume the reader will agree with its specifics. It does assume that the questions it asks are worth asking, and that working answers are needed even where final answers are not yet possible.

1. Where this begins: the AnchorPoint

Spiralweb begins from a recognisable scene. A person stands on a piece of land, or in a school courtyard, or at the edge of a wetland, and something is at stake. The water has dropped. The soil is tired. A child is asking what the world will look like in twenty years. An elder is holding a memory of how the place once was. A farmer has decided not to bore deeper for water and is trying something else. A teacher is wondering whether a school garden can teach more than agriculture. None of this is hypothetical. The work begins where someone has already begun.

This is what an AnchorPoint is. It is not a project. It is not a node in a database. It is not a case study. It is a place where human time, ecological time, and institutional time meet — where a steward, or a small group, has begun to carry something that would otherwise be lost, and where the work they are doing is real enough that it can be observed, supported, and held over time.

1.1 Romance of the Commons

Before the architecture can be set out, it is worth saying clearly what it exists to protect. The previous sections of this report describe what Regenerative Reciprocity refuses: extractive funding, donor capture, performative reporting, hidden depletion, project dryout. That refusal is necessary, but it is not the whole story. An architecture built only against harm becomes brittle. The streams, the formats, the Red Phase Protocol, the non-compensatory rule — none of these matter unless something is being protected.

What is being protected is the possibility that people can fall in love with the commons again. With soil. With water. With species that return when conditions allow. With the children who will inherit the watershed. With the local places that are not abstractions on a map but lived geographies of memory, food, weather, and seasonal rhythm. With the shared life-supporting conditions that no individual can hold alone and that no market can produce. **Commons are not only scarce resources to be managed. They are shared life-supporting conditions to be tended.**

This is not sentimental. It is operational. People who do not love the commons will not protect them through one funding cycle, let alone through the multi-decadal time required for ecological repair. Stewards who carry a piece of land for twenty years do not do it because the project plan said so. They do it because something has happened to them — a relationship has formed with a place that has become irreversible. The work survives because of that relationship, not because of the funding around it.

But love for the commons needs a form. Without ledger, governance, boundaries, and honest accounting, love can become fog, burnout, or hidden extraction. People who love a place can quietly destroy themselves carrying it. People who love a movement can quietly absorb its surplus into their own livelihoods without intending to. People who love an idea can quietly substitute the idea for the real conditions under which it would have to be enacted. Love without form does not save anything; it loses itself. And without love, ledger becomes dead bureaucracy. A field documented only because the funder requires documentation produces statistics, not stewardship.

> **Regenerative Reciprocity begins from the possibility that people can fall in love with the commons again — with soil, water, species, children, local places, and shared futures — and that such love needs a financial form that does not destroy it.**

This is the underlying claim of the architecture. The streams are not bureaucratic categories. They are forms within which care can be carried without being lost. The Red Phase Protocol is not a procedure. It is the condition under which a steward can say "this is too much" and remain in the relationship. The non-compensatory rule is not an accounting convention. It is a protection of the people closest to the work against being silently consumed by the metrics that surround them. The reciprocity bands are not percentages. They are calibrations of when a field has become strong enough to give something back without weakening itself.

The mature formulation, which this report holds throughout, is brief: **romance without ledger can become fog. Ledger without romance can become dead bureaucracy. Together they can become stewardship.** Neither is sufficient on its own. The architecture proposed in this report is the attempt to keep both legible at once.

It also follows from this that **before financial architecture acts, it must pause long enough to read the field. Regenerative Reciprocity begins not with design, but with attention.** A funder who arrives with a plan before the field has spoken has already begun extraction. A protocol that imposes its rhythm before the place has revealed its own has already begun displacement. The architecture in this report is calibrated to slow down at the point of entry, to listen before allocating, and to allow the field to set the pace of its own legibility.

What follows in the rest of this section is the architecture's grounding in actual people and places. It is set out plainly, but the reader should hold the underlying principle: every form below — every stream, every band, every protocol — exists because something living is being protected, and because the form is what allows the love to remain real over time.

1.2 The AnchorPoint is relational, not administrative

The AnchorPoint is defined first by relationship and second by geography. A piece of land alone is not an AnchorPoint. A funded project alone is not an AnchorPoint. What makes a place an AnchorPoint is the presence of a person — or, more often, a small group — who is in steady relationship with the place, who knows it across seasons, who can read what is changing, and who carries the work without needing constant external direction. The AnchorPoint contact is not an administrator. They are a human bridge between the lived reality of a place and the wider architecture that hopes to support it.

This matters because it determines what kind of support is possible. A project can be funded. A relationship can only be carried. The economic architecture in this report is built for the second case.

It also follows that **AnchorPoint sovereignty does not mean isolation from the network. It means that each place remains rooted in its own rhythm, context, people, and ecological reality.** An AnchorPoint that has entered relationship with the wider Spiralweb architecture remains the holder of its own decisions. Network membership does not transfer authority; it offers shared infrastructure, peer relationship, documentation form, and — where conditions allow — material support. The local rhythm is the rhythm. The field's own knowledge of itself is the primary text. Everything the network adds must remain compatible with that rooted sovereignty or it is not adding; it is overriding.

1.3 Bounded practice, relational forms, AnchorPoints, and bioregions

Spiralweb does not prescribe one universal ladder of scale. It distinguishes several relational forms whose boundaries and authority must remain clear.

The smallest practical entry is a **bounded local practice**: a place, relation, or question that a person or group can return to honestly. Ten square metres can be a useful learning scale in some land-based settings, but it is not a universal unit, an entry requirement, or a claim of application status. A balcony, garden corner, school plot, wetland edge, grazing route, street, watershed question, or larger field may each require a different boundary. Open practice can remain complete at this level without entering institutional relationship.

A **steward or local holder** carries continuity and consequence. The holder may be one person or an existing collective form. A Circle of 13 can be valuable where locally chosen, but no fixed number creates governance, representation, consent, or readiness. Those qualities arise from accountable relationships and the capacity to correct.

An **AnchorPoint** is a relational threshold through which a place-bound continuity may meet the wider Spiralweb architecture. It is not automatically a project, a Circle of 13, a funded node, or an active field cycle. Relationship status, local authority, application status, evidence cadence, and support status must be distinguished rather than compressed into the word active.

A **bioregional pattern** may emerge when several locally grounded applications and relationships can learn or circulate capacity across an ecological and cultural region — a watershed, valley, coastal zone, dryland mosaic, or metropolitan habitat. This cannot be commanded by funding or inferred from proximity. Wider flow is legitimate only when the underlying places remain able to hold their own decisions, membranes, and right of correction.

1.4 The current Spiralweb field relationships

At the time of this report, Spiralweb holds named relationships in Kitgum, Doukkala, Had Soualem, Casablanca, Mexico City, and Karachi. They do not share one operational status. Some are active steward or project relationships while a bounded application, selected site, field cycle, or regular evidence cadence remains unactivated; others are preparing locally defined inquiry. Casablanca is a coordination relation rather than an operational field. Inclusion here records relationship and relevance, not readiness, protocol activation, or verified outcome. Current phase, local authority, evidence status, and next decision belong on the relevant public field record and should not be inferred from this report.

These are not interchangeable. The work in Kitgum is not the work in Karachi. Doukkala is not Xochimilco. Each field relationship carries its own ecological, cultural, governance, and economic conditions, and the architecture this report describes is designed to support that difference rather than to standardise it.

Local stewards are not identified by name in this public report. **Consent is not a one-time checkbox. It is an ongoing field condition.** Field participation, use of images, publication, naming, support flows, and partnership status must all remain revisable. In public materials, names, photographs, school identities, precise locations, and personal circumstances are omitted or generalised unless explicit and current permission makes their inclusion necessary and appropriate. This is especially important where children, schools, land tenure, political vulnerability, or economic hardship are involved. Documentation must not become a form of exposure. Visibility is in service of the field, not in service of the report.

Food, soil, and water across these fields are not only outputs, inputs, or indicators. They are **living relationships** through which stewardship becomes visible. A water condition in Doukkala is not a number; it is a question about how rain, soil, reservoirs, trees, animals, and steward judgement meet in one place. A school garden contemplated in Karachi is not merely a deliverable; it would be a place where children could learn that something can grow under their care. The architecture must remain compatible with this relational reality, not displace it.

1.5 How the relation actually becomes real

The architecture described in the rest of this report — formats, streams, bands, protocols, agreements — only matters because something has happened first that none of those forms can produce. A relation has begun. It is worth describing that beginning honestly, because the entire architecture rests on it.

Consider how an AnchorPoint relation actually forms. Someone stands on a piece of land somewhere in the world. A steward in Doukkala, perhaps. They say something like: *the land must be read before planting expands; water, soil, animals, trees, and people have to be understood together.* There is land. There is risk. It is not a project. It is their life. Someone listens. They promise nothing. They take it in. That is the first relation, and it has nothing yet to do with money.

Later, perhaps in another country, that same listener sits with another person — not a donor, not a target, just a person. They do not say "we have a project" or "we need support." They say something more precise: *I was somewhere in Morocco. I met a man who is trying to keep his land alive without destroying it. I cannot let it go.* And then they wait. If the person across from them feels nothing, nothing happens, and that is acceptable. If they feel something, they ask: *what are you doing about it?* The answer, when it is honest, is not a pitch: *I am not trying to solve it. I am trying to keep the connection open. And to make it possible for that work to continue without being taken over.*

It is only at this point — after the relation has been established, after a real person has been brought into the room, after the listener has decided not to turn away — that economy can be mentioned without distorting what has just happened. The sentence is brief: *it takes time and resources to keep being in this. I cannot carry it alone.* Then silence. Not "will you support?" Not "can you help?" Only the truth.

If the relation is real, the other person moves on their own: *what does that mean concretely?* The answer, again, is plain: *that I can keep going there. That we can document what actually works. That this does not become another project that disappears.* The decision then takes one of two forms — *I would like to be part of this* or *I cannot right now* — and both are correct. The point is not which answer comes. The point is that nothing was extracted to produce it. The economy emerged as a consequence of relation, not as a condition for it.

This is what an AnchorPoint relation is, in the form it takes between human beings. Without this layer, the rest of the architecture becomes administrative. With it, the architecture has something to protect. The forms in the rest of this report — Format 5, the reciprocity bands, the AnchorPoint Agreement, the country annex — exist to keep this kind of relation possible at scale, not to substitute for it.

This has a direct editorial consequence for how AnchorPoints are presented in public materials. An AnchorPoint page should not lead with hectares, indicators, or project descriptions. It should lead with a person and a place. *A steward is working with dryland conditions in Doukkala, trying another path after seeing what happens when water is pressed too hard — not because it is safe, but because it is necessary.* Then a pause. Then one sentence: *if you wish to stand in relation to this place, you can help carry the work that is already underway.* Nothing more. The data, the formats, the indicators all sit beneath this — necessary infrastructure, but never the entry point. The entry point is the person.

1.6 The decisive question

Behind every observation, every transfer, every protocol decision in this architecture sits the same question that SRIP places at the centre of stewardship practice: *is this giving to life, or is it taking from life?* The question applies not only to land practice but to the financial form around it. A transfer that strengthens steward viability, supports ecological repair, and clarifies governance is giving to life. A transfer that creates pressure, distorts local decision-making, or generates obligation that displaces stewardship is taking from life. The architecture proposed in the rest of this report is calibrated to the first and designed to refuse the second.

This is not a slogan. It is the test that every operational decision in this architecture is held against. Report 06, Section 8 returns to it in detail when it sets out the guardrails. the Operational Handbook, Section 2 returns to it in the Red Phase Protocol. the Operational Handbook, Section 5 returns to it in the legal classification of flows. The reader will encounter it throughout because it is the rule against which the architecture's specifics are evaluated.

1.7 What the rest of the report is for

The rest of this report describes how money can enter, move through, and where appropriate return from this network of AnchorPoints without distorting them. The principle is simple. Where a real person, in a real place, has begun real work, support should be able to reach them in a form that strengthens the work without taking it over. The form of that support is what this report sets out.

2. The structural problem: why regenerative initiatives dry out

Many regenerative initiatives do not fail because the people involved lack care or competence. They fail, or remain fragile, because the financial form around them is structurally misaligned with the work. Understanding this is a precondition for understanding why Regenerative Reciprocity exists.

2.1 The project-cycle pattern

The dominant pattern in regenerative funding is project-based. A local initiative identifies a need. It writes an application. It competes against other initiatives for a finite philanthropic or grant pool. If successful, it receives temporary support — twelve months, twenty-four months, occasionally thirty-six. It adapts its language to the funder's priorities, often subtly reshaping what it actually does. It produces reports against indicators chosen by external evaluators. The funding cycle ends. It must compete again for the next round, often re-justifying the same work in new terms to a new funder.

This pattern produces five predictable outcomes. The first is **scarcity-driven competition**: regenerative actors who should be collaborators become rivals for the same pool of money. The second is **strategic mimicry**: each initiative learns to speak the language of funders rather than the language of its own soil, water, and community. The third is **fragmentation**: the work splits into discrete projects with formal start and end dates, even when the underlying ecological and social work is continuous and multi-decadal. The fourth is **performative reporting**: indicators and metrics are produced because they are required, regardless of whether they match what is actually happening on the ground. The fifth is **dryout**: when funding ends, the field is left to compete again, and many simply stop.

The deeper problem behind these five outcomes is a category mistake. **Regeneration is not primarily a project category. It is a sustained posture of tending, observation, repair, and long-horizon responsibility.** Project-cycle funding can support some of this work some of the time, but it cannot produce the underlying posture. Where the funding form treats regenerative work as if it were a series of bounded projects, the work itself begins to fragment to fit the form. The form wins; the work loses.

2.2 What a field actually needs

A regenerative field does not only need money. Treating money as the primary organising input is itself part of the problem. A field needs continuity over multi-year horizons; local trust between people who can carry decisions together; steward viability so that the people doing the work can live; ecological observation that is honest rather than promotional; governance clarity so that decisions are documented and conflicts can be addressed; documentation that records what is actually happening; basic infrastructure such as tools, transport, and meeting space; the dignified possibility of pause and withdrawal when life requires it; the capacity to receive support without being distorted by it; and, eventually, the capacity to return capacity outward without being extracted.

Money supports several of these, but it does not produce any of them. Money badly placed actively destroys some — particularly trust, viability, and honest observation. The design problem is therefore not how to bring more money into regenerative work. The design problem is this: how can money enter living fields without becoming sovereign over them?

2.3 What Spiralweb proposes instead

Spiralweb's answer is not "more funding." It is **flow architecture**. The shift is from project to flow, from grant to documented relationship, from reporting to PG Ledger, from beneficiary to steward, from donor to patron-without-control. None of these shifts is rhetorical. Each requires specific structural choices, and the rest of this report sets them out.

The core sequence is straightforward to describe. A real person and place are recognised. A bounded practice begins or is already underway. Where a place-bound application authorises it, locally selected observations, decisions, and financial records may enter the relevant PG Ledger functions or equivalent place-bound records. Three streams are read separately: land and ecology, steward viability, governance and collaboration. Support enters at the level the field can hold, in small initial transfers, with clear classification of every flow. As the field matures, local capacity strengthens. When viability becomes abundance — and only then — the AnchorPoint begins to circulate capacity back to shared infrastructure and outward to other fields.

Philanthropy in this model does not "complete" a project. It enters a living pattern and helps it become reciprocal. That is the difference, and the rest of the report is the working-out of what that difference requires.

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3. The Spiralweb ground

Before describing what Regenerative Reciprocity adds, this section sets out what Spiralweb already has in place. The architecture proposed in this report does not begin from zero; it extends an existing body of work that includes the AnchorPoint structure, the PG Ledger formats, the three-stream separation, and the SRIP (Steward Regenerative Integration Protocol) framework.

3.1 Five candidate PG Ledger tools

PG Ledger is not a single document, database, or mandatory bundle of forms. It is a place-bound memory, flow, evidence, and correction architecture. Five printable tools are publicly available from the Operational Formats section of papers.spiralweb.earth. They may support that architecture where a local application chooses them, but no field is required to use all five and the tools do not create authority or activation.

Format 1 — Steward Monthly Dashboard. A possible one-page review across Land and Ecology, Steward Viability, and Governance and Collaboration. Monthly review and green/yellow/red language are optional design choices. Where used, the reading is a reasoned human judgement that supports discussion about pause, support, action, or review; it is not an automated status and cannot certify a field.

Format 2 — Observation Sheet. A possible place-bound record using locally selected prompts. The published sheet includes eight land-based prompts as a starter grammar, but applications may adapt, replace, reduce, or omit them. The cadence may be event-based, seasonal, periodic, or deliberately sparse.

Format 3 — 30-Day Action Sheet. A possible bounded-action record naming what will be done, who carries it, what will not be done, and when the decision will be revisited. Thirty days is a practical example rather than a universal action cycle.

Format 4 — Governance and Decision Log. A possible decision-memory record for contexts where roles, conditions, consent, conflicts, and revision points need to remain traceable over time.

Format 5 — Financial Ledger. A possible financial traceability record connecting money to purpose, legal classification, stream, and observed effect. Where association-held support enters a place-bound relationship, proportionate financial traceability is required; the published one-page form is one implementation and does not replace formal accounting, agreements, receipts, or statutory reporting.

3.2 The three non-compensatory streams

The three streams are not identical to the five tools. They are distinct lenses through which a place-bound application may read whether ecological work, human carrying capacity, and governance remain compatible. They may be held through the published formats, existing local records, meetings, narrative review, or another locally accountable form.

Stream A — Land and Ecology. What is happening in the living place: soil, water, biodiversity, succession, biomass, food, habitat, and resilience, together with uncertainty and locally meaningful indicators.

Stream B — Steward Viability. What is happening to the people carrying the work: energy, pressure, capacity, presence, fatigue, livelihood, care, and hidden labour.

Stream C — Governance and Collaboration. What is happening in the relational and institutional structure: local authority, agreements, decisions, roles, consent, conflict resolution, external relationships, and the right of correction.

3.3 The non-compensatory rule

The streams are structurally distinct, and this distinction is enforced. No strength in one stream can justify or mask weakness in another. A field with strong Stream A (ecological progress) but red Stream B (a burnt-out steward) is not a green field; it is a field in protective phase, and the burnout must be addressed before any expansion of land work. A field with neat Stream C (clean governance) but degraded Stream A is not a green field; the soil reality is the soil reality. A field with charismatic narrative but no honest observation is not a field at all; it is a story.

This rule prevents three failure modes that destroy most regenerative initiatives. It prevents ecological success masking human burnout. It prevents governance neatness masking ecological decline. And it prevents narrative coherence masking either of these. Any locally chosen review form must keep the streams separate and must not describe the whole field as green while one dimension is in serious trouble.

The structural guardrail is operational, not aspirational. SRIP states it directly: if Stream B goes yellow, slow Stream A. If Stream B goes red, pause Stream A entirely. If Stream C goes red, pause new commitments. If Stream A goes red, stop escalation and focus only on minimum care. The guardrail is not punitive; it is protective. Ecological ambition must not be financed by human depletion. The carrying capacity of the steward is not a personal matter — it is a governance condition.

3.4 The three financial streams

The same three-stream architecture organises financial flow. When support enters the system, it is allocated to one of three financial streams that correspond to — but are operationally separate from — the observation streams of Stream A, B, and C.

Financial Stream A — Land and Ecology funding supports the work that happens on the ground. Trees, seeds, soil work, water retention, tools, nursery development, compost systems, ecological monitoring, local ecological training.

Financial Stream B — Steward Viability funding supports the people carrying the field. Modest stipends, coordination time, food and transport during field days, rest capacity, documentation support, translation, care for elder and youth participation, livelihood buffer during transition. The Constitutional Ground document is explicit on this: land cannot be healed through hidden human depletion, and ecological ambition must not be financed by human burnout.

Financial Stream C — Governance and Collaboration funding supports the institutional and relational infrastructure that holds the work together: proportionate coordination and review, selected PG Ledger records, accounting and receipts, consented evidence storage, local meeting costs, legal and compliance support, reporting, and translation between local practice and shared architecture.

The rule is the same as for the observation streams: a donor must not fund Financial Stream A while Stream B quietly burns out. A field must not show Stream A progress while Stream C becomes opaque. A local surplus must not be extracted while the people holding the field are unstable. Each stream is read separately, supported separately, and reported separately.

3.5 What is in place and what remains to be tested

What Spiralweb already has is substantial. Five candidate PG Ledger tools are documented and downloadable. AnchorPoints are articulated as relational thresholds rather than automatic field status. The three-stream separation is established as a constitutional and governance principle across SRIP and the Penguin Dashboard. Constitutional Ground and Support, Funding, and Patron Pathways set out the basic relational architecture for non-capture support. Reports 01–05 establish the wider ethical and operational framework. None of these public records alone proves that a place-bound application or field cycle is active.

What is missing is the explicit financial architecture: the rules and forms by which support enters, moves, is documented, and where appropriate returns. That is what this report adds. The next section begins by identifying the specific gap and proposing the missing fifth format.

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4. The financial layer: Format 5 — Financial Ledger

The first four public PG Ledger tools offer possible surfaces for shared reading, place-bound observation, bounded action, and decision memory. A local application may use some, all, or none of them. Their common limitation is that they do not explicitly connect association-held financial flow to purpose, legal classification, and observed field effect.

This is a structural gap wherever support is actually held. Money can otherwise move in parallel to the field, recorded only in a formal accounting layer that does not show how a transfer related to local purpose and consequence. Financial traceability must therefore connect formal accounts with a proportionate field-facing record, without making every field adopt the same documentation bundle.

This report introduced a fifth operational format to close that gap. The Financial Ledger is now published alongside Formats 1–4.

4.1 Format 5 — Financial Ledger

Format 5 is the fifth PG Ledger format and has the same character as the first four. It is not an accounting spreadsheet. It is not a KPI dashboard. It is a one-page registration of money in the same observational mode as the other formats — what came in, what was spent, on what, and what visible effect it had on the field, the steward, or the group.

A single entry in Format 5 is light. At minimum it records the date, the amount, the currency, the legal classification (donation, grant, membership, service payment, salary, reimbursement, reciprocity contribution), the recipient, the financial stream (A, B, or C), the purpose, and a short note linking the spend to the field reality it produced.

A worked example: rather than the entry "*expense: 1,200 DKK*", Format 5 records "*12 May 2026 — 1,200 DKK — Stream A — water pipe — installed at northern edge of plot, functioning, reduced manual carrying* *during field days*." This is light. It is one line. It connects money to action to lived effect. It makes the money-to-life link traceable without bureaucratising it.

The minimum fields a Format 5 entry should contain are: date; amount; currency; exchange rate where relevant; sender or source category; recipient; legal classification (donation, grant, membership, reimbursement, salary, service payment, reciprocity contribution, or other); financial stream (A, B, or C); purpose; transfer method; receipt or evidence reference where available; observed field effect; consent or privacy note where photographs, names, or minors are involved; and reviewed-by identifier where the transfer is above the internal threshold defined in the Operational Handbook, Section 4.2. Format 5 remains an operational ledger, not the formal accounting record. Its function is to connect money to field reality in a form that stewards, coordinators, board members, banks, and donors can all understand.

Format 5 is published alongside Formats 1–4 in the Operational Formats section of papers.spiralweb.earth. Its fields, examples, and reporting burden remain subject to revision as the first AnchorPoints test it in operation.

4.2 What Format 5 prevents

Format 5 is designed to prevent three failure modes that destroy most attempts at transparent regenerative finance.

The first is **opacity**. Without a financial format that operates in the same observational mode as the others, money becomes a parallel system that is reported separately, often only annually, and often only to external auditors. The field cannot see its own money. Format 5 is read alongside the other four formats and is read by the same people.

The second is **abstraction**. Conventional accounting registers transactions as numbers detached from what they produced. Format 5 requires the link to lived effect: what was bought, what changed because of it, what the steward observed afterwards. This makes manipulation harder and honesty easier.

The third is **disconnection**. When money moves in a separate channel from observation, the system loses the ability to ask whether spending matched reality. With Format 5 embedded in PG Ledger, the question "was the money used as intended, and did it produce what was hoped for?" becomes answerable inside the same framework that registers ecological and human condition.

4.3 Format 5 and formal accounting: a clean distinction

Format 5 does not replace formal accounting. The association still maintains its books, its bank reconciliation, its annual reporting, and its compliance with Danish association law. Format 5 is not the legal record; it is the operational record. It exists alongside formal accounting, not instead of it.

The clean formulation, which the association holds to throughout its operations, is this: **Format 5 is the field-legibility layer. Formal accounting remains with the association's bookkeeping, bank**

reconciliation, receipts, annual reporting, policy framework, and Bank Pack. Format 5 connects money to field reality; it does not replace the legal accounting record.

This distinction is essential for bankability. A bank's compliance officer, a foundation's due-diligence team, or an external auditor reviewing the architecture must always be able to receive a clean answer to the question "where is the formal accounting?" The answer is: it sits in the association's standard bookkeeping, governed by Danish association law and the Bank Pack documentation. Format 5 sits alongside, providing field legibility that formal accounting alone cannot provide. The two layers are read together by the association's working team but remain legally and procedurally distinct.

Format 5 also does not replace the AnchorPoint Agreement (the Operational Handbook, Section 5.5) or the country annex (the Operational Handbook, Section 5.6). It is a registration format, not a contractual document. It records what happened; the contract specifies what should happen.

4.4 How the tools may work together

The five public tools describe distinct functions that may be combined where useful:

1. **Format 1 — Dashboard.** Supports a reasoned reading across the three streams at a locally chosen cadence.
2. **Format 2 — Observation Sheet.** Holds locally selected observation prompts.
3. **Format 3 — Action Sheet.** Names a bounded next action, responsibility, and review point.
4. **Format 4 — Decision Log.** Holds decision memory and conditions for revision.
5. **Format 5 — Financial Ledger.** Connects money to purpose, classification, and observed effect.

The architecture does not require all five tools to be present. A self-start practice may use none. A place-bound application may select only what it can carry. A supported financial relationship does require proportionate financial traceability and human review, but those functions may be implemented through the published forms or through equivalent locally and legally suitable records. Reciprocity depends on real ecological stability, steward viability, functioning governance, and evidenced surplus — not on completion of a five-form checklist.

Format 5 is therefore one candidate financial field-legibility surface within the wider PG Ledger architecture. It becomes relevant where money actually enters and must remain traceable to life, while formal accounting retains its separate legal authority.

5. The three streams in operation

Section 3.3 introduced the three streams as a constitutional principle. This section describes how they operate financially. The principle is simple: every payment, every receipt, every allocation is identifiable as belonging to one stream, and the streams are not allowed to compensate for one another.

5.1 Stream allocation

When support enters the system, it is allocated to streams either by the donor's specified intent (where they have one) or by a default allocation rule that the association applies in the absence of specific guidance. A typical default allocation for unrestricted support might be Stream A (Land and Ecology) 50%, Stream B (Steward Viability) 30%, Stream C (Governance and Collaboration) 20%, with the proportions adjusted for the maturity of the receiving relationship or application and the visible balance across the three streams and relevant records. A relationship or application in an early preparatory phase will usually need a higher proportion of Stream B and Stream C than one with an established rhythm and several years of practice.

The allocation is not concealed. It is recorded in Format 5 or an equivalent financial record and visible in the AnchorPoint's locally agreed financial status or review record. The recipient knows which stream each transfer belongs to and reports against it accordingly.

5.2 The non-compensatory rule, financially

The three-stream separation is enforced by accounting practice, not just by intent. If a Stream A allocation is underspent because trees and tools cost less than expected, the residual does not automatically transfer to Stream B to cover steward costs. The residual is held, the underspend is documented, and a deliberate decision is made about whether to extend the Stream A work, return the residual to the AnchorPoint reserve, or — only with explicit governance approval and donor-side acceptance — reallocate.

This is operationally less convenient than blended budgets. It is also what prevents the most common failure mode in regenerative finance, in which Stream A appears successful because it absorbed funding intended for Stream B, while the steward quietly carries the unfunded burden.

5.3 What Stream B actually pays for

Stream B requires its own subsection because it is the stream most regenerative initiatives fail to fund explicitly. Stream B is not "overhead." It is not "administration." It is the cost of the people carrying the work being able to live, rest, and continue.

A Stream B budget for an AnchorPoint typically includes a modest steward stipend or honorarium, paid at a level that reflects local cost of living rather than international scale; coordination time for the AnchorPoint contact; food and transport during field days; documentation support, including translation where the working languages of the field and the association differ; care for elder and youth participation, where unpaid carrying of cultural memory or learning would otherwise fall on individuals; and a livelihood buffer for stewards in transition from prior work.

The Stream B budget is calibrated to local reality. A 6,000 DKK monthly steward stipend is generous in some contexts and inadequate in others. The figure is not the principle; the principle is that the steward is not expected to carry the work on uncompensated labour.

Two principles sit beneath the Stream B budget and govern how it is read. The first concerns rest: **rest is not a reward for productive fields; it is part of field viability. Burnout is not evidence of**

commitment. It is evidence that a boundary has failed. A budget that funds activity but not rest is funding eventual collapse. The second concerns what a budget can and cannot legitimately cost: **no budget should be considered viable if it depends on the loss of human breath — chronic stress, unpaid overload, or the collapse of steward capacity.** If meeting the field's stated outputs requires extracting from the steward's body or life, the outputs must be reduced, not the steward.

5.4 What Stream C actually pays for

Stream C is the institutional infrastructure that holds the work together. It may include proportionate AnchorPoint coordination, locally agreed review, selected PG Ledger records, accounting and receipts management, consented evidence storage, local meeting costs, legal and compliance support including AML and country-annex work, reporting where required, and translation between the field and the wider Spiralweb infrastructure.

Stream C is also calibrated to maturity. An AnchorPoint in an early preparatory phase needs more Stream C than one with an established rhythm (see the Operational Handbook, Section 2.4) — the early work of agreement-making, country-annex preparation, and ledger setup is heavier than the later work of continuation and review.

5.5 The fourth movement: reciprocity

The three streams describe how support enters and stabilises a field. Regenerative Reciprocity adds a fourth movement, which is not a fourth budget stream in the same sense but a circulation rule: when the field becomes strong enough to carry it, capacity moves back and outward.

Section 7 describes reciprocity in full. It is mentioned here because the streams are the foundation on which reciprocity rests. A field cannot circulate capacity until all three streams are stable. A field showing Stream A success while Stream B is depleted is not a candidate for reciprocity, regardless of its visible output.

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6. Regenerative Reciprocity: definition and rule

Regenerative Reciprocity is the central proposal of this report. This section defines it clearly, sets out what it is not, and states the rule that governs it.

6.1 Definition

Regenerative Reciprocity is the calibrated return and outward circulation of capacity from an AnchorPoint that has become stronger through shared support, without creating debt, extraction, ownership, or control.

It rests on a single observation. A regenerative field that has been carried by the commons through its early years can, when it becomes strong enough, begin to carry the commons in return. This is not repayment; the support that helped the field stabilise was not a loan. It is not investor return; no equity was held. It is not profit-sharing; the field's surplus belongs to the field and its stewards. It is not donor reward; the patron does not receive recognition or status.

It is, instead, the continuation of a flow that was begun by others. When a field has stabilised and produces real net surplus, a calibrated portion of that surplus circulates: back to the shared infrastructure that made the field's documentation, governance, and support possible; outward to other AnchorPoints that are still in their fragile early years; and into bioregional pools that carry capacity across the network. The point is not to return what was given. The point is to prevent flow from stopping.

6.2 What it is not

Regenerative Reciprocity is not loan repayment. It is not investor return. It is not profit-sharing. It is not a donor reward programme. It is not a franchise fee. It is not a tax on the field. It is not centralised redistribution. It is not an obligation triggered before viability.

It is also not philanthropic recycling in the sense that grants sometimes operate, where a foundation requires its grantees to fund peer organisations as a condition of receiving the grant. Regenerative Reciprocity is voluntary, calibrated, and never activated against a field's own viability.

6.3 What it is

Regenerative Reciprocity is the acknowledgement of received support without the structure of debt. It is the protection of the network against one-way dependency. It is contribution to shared infrastructure by those who have benefited from it. It is peer-to-peer field support across AnchorPoints. It is bioregional circulation. It is commons replenishment. It is gratitude made operational rather than rhetorical.

6.4 The rule

The rule that governs Regenerative Reciprocity is simple and absolute:

> **When abundance emerges, flow continues. When fragility is present, fragility is protected.**

No reciprocity is expected from a field in red. No reciprocity is expected from a field in yellow. No reciprocity is expected from a field in green that has not been stable for at least six to twelve months. No reciprocity is calculated on gross income; it is calculated on net regenerative surplus, defined as what remains after local wages, field costs, soil and water reinvestment, steward viability, reserves, and local obligations have been met.

Only when all of those have been honestly accounted for does the question of reciprocity arise, and even then the bands are modest: 3–5% of net surplus for green fields, 5–10% for deep green fields. The remainder — 90% or more — stays with the field. Reciprocity is a circulation rule, not an extraction rule.

6.5 Neither market nor pure gift

It is worth naming clearly what kind of economic form Regenerative Reciprocity is, because it is easy to mistake it for something it is not.

It is not a market form. In a market form, the relation is reduced to transaction; value is measured in price; and what cannot be priced disappears. Regenerative Reciprocity does not reduce a field to its yields, does not price a steward's care, and does not treat the AnchorPoint as a unit of production. The relation is primary; the economy is a consequence.

It is not a pure gift economy either. In a pure gift form, economic clarity is treated as suspicious, and someone usually ends up paying the hidden price — most often the people closest to the work. Spiralweb's Constitutional Ground is explicit on this: land cannot be healed through hidden human depletion, and ecological ambition must not be financed by human burnout. A purely gift-based form would protect the rhetoric of non-extraction while quietly producing extraction in practice. Regenerative Reciprocity refuses that trade.

What Regenerative Reciprocity proposes is a third form. The relation is primary. The economy is secondary, but explicit. Money is necessary, and that is said clearly. Money does not buy control. The field's existence does not depend on any single transaction. The steward is not expected to subsidise the architecture's purity with their own life. None of these can fail without the form collapsing back into either market dominance or hidden self-exploitation.

One further clarification follows from this third form, and it must be stated carefully so that the architecture remains legally and financially serious. **Regenerative Reciprocity does not abolish contracts or accounting. It prevents contracts and accounting from becoming the whole relationship.** A bank cannot operate without contracts. An association cannot meet its legal duties without accounting. A patron cannot transfer significant capital without documentation. The architecture in this report does not weaken any of those. What it refuses is the reduction of the entire relationship to its contractual and accounting layers, as if the legal documents alone could carry what the work actually requires. The contract holds the form; the relationship carries the life. Both are necessary, and neither can substitute for the other.

This third form is not standardised. It is being designed in practice across the AnchorPoints described in this report. The architecture is provisional. What is non-negotiable is the structural commitment: a relation can carry money without becoming a market, and an economy can be honest without becoming extractive. Whether that commitment can be sustained over time is the open question this report does not pretend to have answered.

7. Reciprocity bands and phases

The reciprocity rule is calibrated by phase. The phase a field is in determines whether reciprocity is expected at all, and if so, at what band. This section sets out the four phases and their corresponding rules.

7.1 Red — Protection Phase

A field is in the Red Phase when at least one of the following conditions is present: land or ecology is stressed (drought, contamination, succession failure, weather event); steward viability is fragile (burnout, illness, family crisis, displacement); governance is unclear (decision deadlock, conflict, leadership absence); a climate or other shock has overwhelmed local capacity; or the steward or AnchorPoint has explicitly named the field as in difficulty.

The rule in Red Phase is: **no financial return expected, expansion stopped, support reconfigured toward repair.** The reciprocity expected from a red field is honest status, a pause note in PG Ledger, evidence of difficulty, and where appropriate documentation of what failed and why. None of these are financial. The budget posture in red is relief, repair, minimum viable care, and explicitly not expansion.

The Red Phase Protocol is described in full in the Operational Handbook, Section 2.2.

7.2 Yellow — Stabilisation Phase

A field is in the Yellow Phase when some progress is visible but the rhythm is unstable, documentation is partial, governance clarity is incomplete, or the steward team is still vulnerable. Yellow is the phase most fields spend most of their time in. It is not a problem; it is honest reality.

The rule in Yellow is: **no fixed return, optional symbolic contribution only.** A yellow field may, if it chooses, contribute a small local consumable (seeds, photos, hosting a peer visit if not burdensome, a small contribution to the shared ledger). None of this is required. The budget posture is consolidation, role clarity, observation rhythm, and modest field support.

7.3 Green — Viability Phase

A field is in the Green Phase when all of the following are true: the field rhythm is stable, the steward team is not depleted, governance is documented and functioning, ecological indicators are improving, and some form of local income or yield has begun to emerge. Green is not high performance. Green is sustainable condition.

The rule in Green is: **calibrated reciprocity begins.** Possible bands are 3–5% of net regenerative surplus to shared infrastructure, 3–5% to local or bioregional outward support, with 90% or more retained locally. The budget posture is continued investment, cautious expansion, shared documentation, and the first structured return.

The most important rule in Green is that green status must never be achieved through hidden depletion. A field reporting green while the steward is exhausted is not green; it is performative green, and the system must be able to catch this. Report 06, Section 8 sets out the guardrails.

7.4 Deep Green — Abundance Phase

A field is in the Deep Green Phase when it produces reliable surplus, local livelihoods have strengthened, governance is mature, ledger discipline is stable, and the field can support others without weakening itself. This phase is rare in early years and is not the goal for most AnchorPoints; it emerges in some places and not others, and that is appropriate.

The rule in Deep Green is: **stronger reciprocity becomes possible.** Possible bands are 5–10% of net surplus to shared infrastructure, 5–10% to bioregional outward support, with 80–90% retained locally. The budget posture is replication support, training, learning-site role, contribution to a bioregional fund, and possibly contribution to commons trust formation.

One principle holds across all four phases and deserves a clear statement: **growth cannot be commanded by funding. A field may only expand when soil, steward viability, and governance can carry the next step.** A patron who wishes to accelerate a field's progression to deep green by increasing the budget will not produce that progression; they will produce overextension followed by collapse. Bloom, surplus, reciprocity, and expansion are conditions that emerge when the underlying ground is ready. They are not conditions that can be purchased or scheduled.

7.5 Calculating net regenerative surplus

The percentage bands are meaningless without a clear definition of what they apply to. **Net regenerative surplus** is what remains after the following have been met in full:

1. Local wages and steward livelihood at a level that does not depend on hidden depletion
2. Field operating costs (tools, transport, materials, repairs)
3. Reinvestment in soil, water, biodiversity, and ecological infrastructure
4. Reserve buffer (typically 10–20% of annual operations)
5. Local obligations (loans, agreements with cooperatives, community commitments)
6. Steward viability buffer (illness, family, transition)

Only after all six have been satisfied does net regenerative surplus exist. The 3–10% bands then apply to that residual. In practice, this means that many fields in green will generate little or no calculable surplus in their first years of green status, and the reciprocity that activates will be small. This is the correct scale. Reciprocity should be visible, real, and modest, not a substantial drain on local viability.

The calculation procedure follows the same restraint as the rule. Net regenerative surplus is calculated no more than once per year, unless the AnchorPoint itself requests an earlier calculation. The calculation is made jointly by the AnchorPoint and the Spiralweb coordinator, drawing on

Format 5, the local accounts, and the steward viability reading from Format 1. No field is asked to calculate reciprocity while in red or yellow. **If there is doubt about whether a surplus is real, the doubt protects the field** — the calculation is deferred rather than forced. Reciprocity is a circulation rule, not an extraction rule, and the procedure that activates it is built to fail in the field's favour rather than against it.

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8. Conditions that keep the architecture non-extractive

The architecture remains regenerative only if its operational forms do not reproduce capture, exposure, hidden obligation, or an increasingly heavy centre. The conditions below are constitutional constraints rather than implementation details. Their procedural expression belongs in the companion Operational Handbook.

8.1 The central design rule

The single most important design rule is this: **the system must be hard to exploit and easy to be truthful in.** Every guardrail is evaluated against that test. A guardrail that makes exploitation harder but also makes honesty harder is the wrong guardrail. A guardrail that makes honesty easier without making exploitation easier is the right guardrail.

The corollary is that the system cannot prevent all dishonesty. Some 10–20% of effort, time, or money will be lost to noise, error, small misalignments, and minor manipulation. The goal is not to eliminate this. The goal is to ensure it does not scale. Structural guardrails make small exploitation visible and large exploitation impossible.

8.2 Documentation must not become exposure

One principle deserves its own subsection because it cuts across every operational layer: **documentation must not become exposure.**

PG Ledger is a documentation architecture. AnchorPoint pages are documentation surfaces. Format 5 entries link money to field reality. Photographs, names, school identities, soil data, water observations, governance decisions, and steward reflections all enter the ledger over time. The architecture's strength is precisely this legibility. But the same legibility, deployed without care, can become a form of harm.

Visibility is only legitimate when it serves the field and is consent-based, proportionate, contextual, and reversible. Images, names, school identities, precise locations, economic vulnerability, land tenure, political sensitivity, and children require particular care. A photograph that helps a foundation understand the work may also expose participants to attention they did not consent to. A name that builds relational warmth in a public report may also place a steward in a position they cannot easily withdraw from. A precise location useful for protocol replication may also expose land tenure that is contested. The default is restraint. The exception, when documentation moves from internal record to public visibility, requires explicit and current consent — not the consent given two years ago at the moment of first relationship, but the consent that holds today, for this particular use.

Field pages should be truth surfaces, not campaign surfaces. The distinction matters. A truth surface records what is real, with the participants' active consent, in a form they themselves can read and correct. A campaign surface deploys the field's reality in service of an external goal — fundraising, profile-building, political advocacy — that may or may not align with what the field itself needs. The two can look identical from outside. They are not the same thing.

This principle connects directly back to consent as ongoing condition (Section 1.4). Consent given is not consent owned. A steward, a school, a Circle of 13, or an AnchorPoint may at any time withdraw permission for further use of images, names, or specific information, and the architecture must be able to honour that withdrawal in practice — not just in policy. Where the association cannot guarantee removal across all downstream uses (third-party publications, partner reports, archived materials), it must say so plainly at the point of original consent, and calibrate what is published accordingly.

8.3 The cultural layer

The deepest guardrail is cultural. Without it, the structural and behavioural layers fail.

The cultural rule is: **a steward must never have to choose between honesty and survival.** If the system produces that choice, stewards will choose survival, and the architecture collapses. The system must therefore make honesty rationally safer than performance.

This requires several things from Spiralweb itself, not from stewards:

- **Showing its own vulnerability.** The association must publish its own yellow and red phases. Stewards cannot be expected to be honest if Spiralweb performs perfection.
- **Not rewarding "perfect green."** No prizes, no special status, no enhanced visibility for fields that always report green. If anything, green that is too consistent is treated as a flag for soft friction.
- **Telling stories about good Red Phases.** When a field has entered red and recovered well, that story is told publicly (with consent), so other stewards see that red is held safely.
- **Never using red as implicit criticism.** Red is reconfiguration, not failure. Internal language must reflect this.

This is the layer that determines whether the rest of the architecture works. Structure and behavioural guardrails can be specified. Culture must be lived. The work of the association is to live it.

A further cultural principle holds throughout this layer: **a regenerative financial system must be kind without becoming vague. It must leave room for pause, correction, role flexibility, and**

learning without dissolving accountability. Grace and rigour are not opposites in this architecture; they are the two sides of the same form. A system that becomes rigid in the name of accountability loses the field; a system that becomes vague in the name of kindness loses the discipline that makes care durable. The work is to hold both at once, in the same conversation, often in the same sentence.

Underlying all of this is a definition of governance that Regenerative Reciprocity holds throughout: **governance in this architecture is not control over a field. It is the structured movement of care, responsibility, evidence, and decision-making through distributed centres of responsibility.** The board is one such centre. An AnchorPoint is another. A locally chosen circle or other accountable review body may be another. A patron in formal agreement is another. None of them is sovereign over the field; all of them carry a portion of the responsibility for keeping the architecture honest.

8.4 The hard truth

Several things will happen regardless of how well the guardrails are designed:

- Some people will perform.
- Some will exaggerate.
- Some will fall away.
- Some will misuse small amounts.
- Some will hide problems.

These are not failures of the system. They are the system's tests. The architecture passes when small misuse remains small, when honest stewards can breathe, and when the system holds its character over time. The architecture fails when small misuse scales, when honesty becomes dangerous, or when the architecture begins to perform itself.

The final test, applied to any specific design choice: **can this be done twelve times in succession without burning out?** If the answer is no, the design is too heavy.

8.5 Practice is open, obligation is not

The deepest guardrail in this architecture is borrowed directly from SRIP and applies to financial flow as much as it does to land practice. The principle: **practice is open; obligation is not.** Anyone may begin a bounded local practice, adapt an openly licensed tool, use the three-stream distinction, or apply Red Phase logic in their own organisation. None of this requires permission, relationship, or membership. But use of a form does not create a Spiralweb application, local authority, review entitlement, field status, or financial relationship.

But beginning practice does not in itself create entitlement to support, review, funding, or institutional relationship. Those things follow more slowly, and only where enough continuity, evidence, and trust are present. The architecture distinguishes clearly among three things:

1. **Practice** — beginning or continuing real local stewardship, with public tools or inquiry grammars used only where they fit.
2. **Recognition** — enough continuity for closer relational attention from the association.
3. **Support** — some form of financial, operational, or institutional backing.

These are not the same. Not everyone who practises will seek recognition. Not everyone recognised will need support. And not everyone seeking support will yet be ready for it. The four user pathways set out in SRIP — self-start steward, learning contact, verified relationship, and supported steward or field relation — apply to this architecture as well. Most people who encounter the architecture will work at the self-start level and never enter financial relationship with the association at all. That is not a weak case. It is a successful one.

The maturity rule is the same as in SRIP: **first stand, then help.** A field that has not yet stabilised its own three streams cannot reasonably be supporting another field. A new AnchorPoint cannot reasonably be receiving large support before the local rhythm is real. A patron cannot reasonably enter at the highest band without first having seen the field at smaller scale. The order matters.

8.6 The 10,000 people burden test

The most important structural test of the architecture is the question SRIP asks of every design choice: *if 10,000 more people did this tomorrow, would the centre become heavier?*

If the answer is yes, the design is wrong. The architecture must be such that:

- 10,000 people can download Format 5 and begin registering financial flow in their own work without anything needing to happen at the Spiralweb centre.
- 10,000 stewards can use the three-stream separation in their own organisations without consultation with the association.
- 10,000 readers can adopt the Red Phase Protocol in their own work without onboarding.
- 10,000 inquiries do not generate 10,000 case files at the centre.

This is what allows the architecture to remain open without becoming captured. Most engagement remains local. Most practice remains self-starting. Most learning happens through reading and adaptation rather than through institutional relationship. The narrowest layer — supported AnchorPoints with formal agreements — remains small enough to be carried by the association's actual capacity.

Flow must not arrive faster than the living system can absorb without distortion. If very large numbers begin, the correct response is not central expansion. The correct response is: let most remain self-starting, let many remain local, let some cluster into circles, let very few enter central relation, and let maturity generate new distributed centres over time. The success condition is not that the association can process everyone. The success condition is that it still does not need to process most of them.

9. Planetary context: why Regenerative Reciprocity is needed at scale

The architecture in the previous sections is operationally specific. This section places it in its planetary context. Regenerative Reciprocity is not a funding mechanism in search of projects. It is one response, among others, to a planetary condition. Without this context, the technical architecture floats free of why it matters.

9.1 Wealth concentration and time poverty

Two realities now exist side by side. On one side, an extremely small global wealth class holds an unprecedented concentration of capital. Recent reporting based on wealth-sector analysis places the global billionaire count above three thousand individuals, with projections toward nearly four thousand within five years. At the broader millionaire level, global financial-asset reporting continues to show large and growing concentrations, with substantial portions of global financial wealth held by a small fraction of the population.

On the other side, billions live without long-term security. The World Bank now defines extreme poverty as living on less than approximately three US dollars per day, and reports that hundreds of millions remain below that threshold. Many more live above it but remain structurally vulnerable to food-price inflation, illness, climate shocks, debt cycles, job disruption, and the loss of informal income.

This is not only an inequality problem. It is a **time-horizon problem**. A person living from day to day cannot easily plant a forest. A family without savings cannot easily wait five years for a food forest to root. A smallholder on degraded land cannot easily take ecological risks when the next harvest is needed for survival. Regenerative work requires time. Poverty removes time. The architecture in this report exists, in part, to give time back — to make it possible for people on land to enter regenerative practice without bearing the entire risk of the transition themselves.

9.2 The smallholder trap

A large part of the planetary crisis is carried by people who are not inactive but overactive under bad conditions. Smallholders, informal workers, land-based families, peri-urban growers, teachers, builders, repair workers, and local stewards often work continuously, yet remain unable to enter a positive spiral. The problem is not lack of will. The problem is the absence of surplus.

Without surplus, a farmer cannot easily shift to agroforestry, restore soil, plant trees with delayed yield, protect seed diversity, pause extractive cultivation, invest in water retention, participate in documentation, join a cooperative structure, or take part in long-term governance. Each of these requires resources that survival agriculture cannot generate.

Regenerative Reciprocity is therefore designed as more than support. It is designed to create the conditions under which people can move from survival work into stewardship work — from carrying the unfunded cost of ecological collapse to being supported in carrying ecological repair. The architecture's purpose is not to fund projects; it is to fund the time and stability that make stewardship possible.

9.3 Food sovereignty and the return of local capacity

Food sovereignty is not only about calories. It is about agency. It means that people and communities can shape their own food systems in ways that are ecologically, culturally, nutritionally, and economically viable. In the Spiralweb context, food sovereignty includes heirloom seeds, local seed banks, crop diversity, agroforestry, school gardens, food forests, local processing, intergenerational knowledge, access to land, local water systems, and community-based resilience.

This is directly connected to the architecture. A field that receives support should not become dependent on continuous external supply. It should gradually increase local capacity, local resilience, and local abundance. The reciprocity rule reinforces this: support enters until viability is real, and then circulates outward rather than continuing to flow inward.

The purpose is not simply to fund food production. The purpose is to restore the conditions under which communities can feed themselves with dignity.

9.4 Biodiversity, seed banks, and species protection

The biodiversity crisis is not an abstract background condition. The Intergovernmental Science-Policy Platform on Biodiversity and Ecosystem Services has estimated that around one million animal and plant species are threatened with extinction, many within decades, unless drivers of biodiversity loss are reduced.

For Spiralweb, this means that regenerative finance must eventually become **habitat finance**. Support must not only ask what human project is being funded; it must also ask what habitat becomes possible, which species may return, which seeds are protected, which ecological relationships are restored.

This reframes the economic question. A restored field is not only a productive unit. It is a living interface where birds return, insects return, water behaviour changes, soil organisms recover, seeds move, local microclimates shift, and human attention deepens. Bounded observation matters because it makes change legible at a scale people can actually revisit and correct. Such a boundary may be 10 m^2 in one setting and entirely different in another. Where locally authorised records are shared through PG Ledger, wider patterns may become visible without treating unlike places as interchangeable pixels.

9.5 Water, forests, and bioregional repair

Water is not only a resource. It is a pattern. The loss of forests, soils, wetlands, and mountain vegetation changes how water moves through a bioregion. The United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification has reported expanding drylands and the need for substantial investment in land restoration and drought resilience.

Restoring forests and tree-based systems can support water regulation, erosion control, habitat, carbon storage, and microclimate stability — but it must be done with hydrological intelligence. The Food and Agriculture Organization's forest-water guidance cautions explicitly against simplistic assumptions that "more trees always means more water"; the relationship depends on context, species, soils, climate, and landscape position.

This matters for the architecture in this report. The aim is not ideological tree planting. The aim is locally intelligent restoration: reforest where forests belong; protect mountain slopes where vegetation anchors water; restore riparian buffers; rebuild soil sponge capacity; support agroforestry where food and canopy can coexist; avoid water-intensive mistakes in drylands; follow local ecological knowledge alongside scientific assessment. In some places, the right direction may be native forest restoration; in others, syntropic agroforestry; in others, wetland repair, seed banking, grazing transition, or soil cover may be the immediate priority. The field must be allowed to reveal what it can become.

9.6 Regeneration is not one land use

A food forest is not a fixed product. It is a living succession. In the first years it is fragile. After several years it begins to root. Over time it may become something not fully predictable at the beginning. Some fields may become diversified food forests; some may become shaded cacao or coffee systems; some may become seed orchards; some may become mixed habitat and food systems; some may move toward semi-wild forest; some may remain intensively managed because local food needs require it.

The same is true socially. An AnchorPoint may begin with one person and land. It may later become a Circle of 13. It may become a school network. It may become a village commons. It may become a regional learning node. It may remain small and precise.

Regenerative Reciprocity must therefore avoid forcing a single outcome. The architecture supports development without overdetermining it. Reciprocity bands are calibrated to what each field can actually carry, not to what an external standard expects.

9.7 War, resource vulnerability, and the return of basic systems

Recent global food-crisis reporting shows that conflict, drought, and aid shortfalls continue to drive severe food insecurity; the 2026 Global Report on Food Crises documents that 266 million people across 47 countries experienced severe food insecurity in 2025.

The geopolitical lesson is clear: centralised life-support systems are vulnerable. When water systems fail, when fertiliser access is disrupted, when desalination plants are damaged, when food imports are blocked, when fuel prices shift, or when housing becomes unsafe, communities discover how dependent they are on distant systems they do not control.

Regeneration is therefore not lifestyle. It is **resilience infrastructure**. This includes local food production, seed sovereignty, water retention, soil repair, safe shelter, decentralised energy, community health resilience, local repair capacity, ecological buffers, and regional cooperation.

Regenerative Reciprocity must be able to support not only beautiful landscapes but basic life-support capacity.

9.8 Cleaning, repair, and the moral work of restoration

Regeneration is not only planting. It is also cleaning. Many landscapes are damaged by heavy metals, polluted water, plastic waste, chemical residues, degraded soils, industrial runoff, abandoned infrastructure, extractive land use, deforestation, overgrazing, and erosion.

Restoration therefore includes unglamorous work: removing waste, testing soils, identifying contamination, rebuilding drainage, repairing water paths, fencing sensitive areas, composting, mulching, protecting young trees, maintaining tools, documenting failures. This matters because regenerative culture can become too symbolic if it does not include repair labour. Regenerative Reciprocity must therefore fund both visible transformation and invisible maintenance — the planted tree and the cleared waste site, the celebrated harvest and the documented failure.

9.9 The market interface: from survival land to ledgered abundance

Spiralweb does not reject markets as such. It rejects extractive market logic as the primary organiser of life. The long-term question is whether existing markets can be influenced, redirected, and partially re-patterned through higher-quality evidence, better governance, and non-extractive financial architecture.

This is especially relevant in relation to high-quality carbon credits, biodiversity credits, water-restoration finance, regenerative supply chains, smallholder aggregation, local food economies, and stewardship-based compensation. The danger is real: carbon markets can simplify living systems into tradable units and invite new forms of capture. The opportunity is also real: if smallholders and local stewards can document ecological improvement over time through PG Ledger, they may eventually access forms of value recognition that were previously unavailable.

The sequence must therefore be unambiguous: **ledger first, market second.** Not market demand first, then field distortion. PG Ledger gives Spiralweb a way to insist that any market interface must remain grounded in land reality, steward viability, group governance, financial transparency, long-term evidence, and the absence of false green. The market interface is a future development of this architecture; it is not its starting point. A separate paper will address it specifically.

9.10 Institutional capital, supply-chain accountability, and conscious co-created food systems

Institutional capital should not be excluded from Regenerative Reciprocity. The question is not whether capital may enter, but under what grammar it enters, what it is allowed to see, what it is allowed to claim, and whether the field remains able to refuse distortion. The architecture in this report is not anti-capital. It is anti-capture. It does not reject carbon finance, supply-chain finance, corporate food-system partnerships, or institutional investment as such. It rejects any arrangement in which capital becomes the first grammar of the field.

This distinction matters because institutional capital is already moving toward land, food, carbon, biodiversity, and nature-based systems. Carbon pricing now covers approximately 28% of global emissions, and carbon-pricing instruments mobilised more than USD 100 billion for public budgets in 2024 (World Bank, 2025). At the same time, carbon-credit supply continued to outstrip demand, with the global pool of unretired credits approaching one billion tonnes in 2024. The lesson is not that carbon markets are irrelevant. The lesson is that scale, liquidity, and climate language do not by themselves guarantee field integrity.

For smallholder agriculture, the risk is sharper. Recent climate-finance analysis identifies unreliable corporate demand, high upfront costs, and asymmetric market incentives as core barriers to making voluntary carbon markets work in agrifood systems (Climate Policy Initiative, 2026). These barriers are precisely the conditions under which local stewards can become the cheapest layer in a high-value claim architecture: they carry practice change, documentation burden, yield risk, tenure uncertainty, and delayed benefit, while others capture methodology, aggregation, verification, trading, branding, and reputational value.

Regenerative Reciprocity therefore proposes a different sequence. Institutional capital may be designed in from the beginning, but carbon credits should not be the beginning. Early capital should first support field integrity: land relationship, steward viability, soil and water work, food sovereignty, local seed systems, baseline observation, PG Ledger practice, consent, governance, and benefit-sharing. Carbon-credit readiness may then be explored later, but only where the field has become strong enough to hold it. Credits may become a later instrument. They are not the first grammar of the field.

This is not a rejection of institutional capital. It is a sequencing discipline. A five-year programme can be designed so that Years 0–2 are dedicated to field integrity, local practice, evidence, and governance; Years 2–3 introduce carbon-readiness assessment, only where appropriate; Years 3–5 may test selective MRV, insetting, contribution finance, or pre-issuance pathways; and only after sufficient field stability should credit issuance be considered. Some fields may become credit-suitable. Others may remain carbon-relevant but not credit-suitable. This distinction is essential. A living field can sequester carbon, restore biodiversity, retain water, strengthen food systems, and build community resilience without needing to become a carbon-credit project.

The same discipline is needed in food supply chains. Much of the global food economy still operates through procurement systems that ask for volume, price, consistency, certification, and delivery, while the conditions that make food possible remain external to the transaction. Buyers may order large quantities through intermediaries with little or no contact with the local practice that produced the food, the soil conditions that were affected, the water systems that were stressed, the biodiversity that was lost or restored, or the human carrying capacity required to deliver the order. The visible value chain records purchase, transport, processing, retail, and margin. The invisible commons absorbs erosion, water depletion, seed loss, chemical exposure, unpaid care, land pressure, local food insecurity, and steward exhaustion.

This is the deeper supply-chain problem: many harms are not absent from the system; they are merely displaced from the balance sheet into the commons. They become externalities because no actor in the formal value chain is required to hold the full life cost of what the chain demands.

FAO's work on the hidden costs of agrifood systems confirms that the market price of food does not reflect the full environmental, social, and health costs generated by current food systems. The 2024 State of Food and Agriculture report quantifies hidden costs across 156 countries at approximately USD 12 trillion annually — around ten percent of global GDP — covering health impacts, environmental degradation, and social costs (FAO, 2024). This is directly relevant to Spiralweb's architecture: the problem is not only that food is underpriced. The problem is that the price is separated from the field conditions, human conditions, and commons conditions that make food possible.

European regulation is also moving, however imperfectly, in this direction. The EU Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive entered into force in July 2024 and requires in-scope companies to identify and address adverse human-rights and environmental impacts across their operations and global value chains (European Parliament and Council, 2024). This does not solve the supply-chain problem, and its scope remains limited and politically contested. But it confirms the direction of travel: companies can no longer assume that harms outside the purchasing contract are outside responsibility.

For land-intensive sectors, science-based target frameworks are also becoming more explicit. SBTi's Forest, Land and Agriculture (FLAG) guidance requires companies in food production, food and beverage processing, food retail, and other land-intensive sectors to set FLAG targets where relevant, including near-term and long-term emissions reduction targets and no-deforestation commitments (SBTi, 2026). Again, this is not enough by itself. But it means that food companies, retailers, processors, and institutional buyers increasingly need credible ways to see and act on land-sector impacts beyond conventional procurement.

This is where **Conscious Co-created Food Systems** becomes relevant. A conscious food system is not only a supply chain with better claims. It is a co-created field relation in which food, soil, water, biodiversity, labour, culture, learning, and governance remain visible together. It asks not only what food is purchased, but what kind of field the purchase strengthens. It asks whether procurement supports local capacity or extracts from it; whether it strengthens seed sovereignty or narrows genetic diversity; whether it improves water retention or intensifies water stress; whether it supports steward viability or depends on unpaid overload; whether it builds local food resilience or channels value outward while leaving the commons depleted.

In this sense, PG Ledger can function as a supply-chain truth surface. It does not replace formal certification, accounting, procurement contracts, due diligence, or food-safety systems. It adds a missing field-legibility layer. It allows carbon, biodiversity, soil, water, food, and human carrying capacity to enter one evidentiary frame without collapsing into one metric. This is especially important where institutional buyers, food companies, foundations, municipalities, schools, or public procurement systems want to support regenerative food systems without turning them into volume-driven commodity pipelines.

> **The aim is not to make local stewards serve supply chains. The aim is to make supply chains answerable to stewardship.**

A conscious co-created food-system partnership should therefore follow several principles. *First*, procurement should not begin with volume. It should begin with field reading. *Second*, the buyer should not treat the local actor as a supplier only, but as a steward whose ecological and human carrying capacity matters. *Third*, price should not be the only economic signal; support may need to include transition finance, documentation support, local processing, seed systems, water infrastructure, and governance capacity. *Fourth*, carbon, biodiversity, water, and social claims should never be made faster than the field can document them. *Fifth*, the field must retain the right to say no to orders, claims, visibility, or credit pathways that would distort its work.

This creates a different capital interface. Institutional capital can enter as **stewardship capital**, not extractive capital: capital deployed to give time back, reduce transition risk, strengthen local practice, and build evidence before claims. It may take the form of grants, concessional capital, first-loss support, buyer-funded transition programmes, contribution finance, insetting, public procurement, or later high-integrity credit pathways. But in each case the sequencing remains the same: **field first, ledger second, market third**.

The mature position is therefore neither anti-market nor market-led. Spiralweb does not reject carbon finance or institutional capital. It rejects carbon-first and procurement-first field design. Capital may enter from the beginning, but it must enter as support for field integrity, not as a demand for premature claims, volumes, or tradable units.

If the architecture succeeds, it may eventually allow many smallholders and local stewards to interface with larger capital systems without being absorbed by them. But this will only be credible if the early architecture protects the field from the very distortions that later scale would otherwise amplify. The issue is not whether capital managers are bad actors, or whether local actors are fragile. The issue is that poorly sequenced incentives can distort even good actors. Regenerative Reciprocity exists to make that sequence visible, governable, and correctable.

9.11 The role of wealth: from ownership to stewardship

The presence of enormous private wealth is one of the defining facts of the present historical moment. The question is not only whether wealthy individuals should give more. The deeper question is: **can wealth move without controlling what it touches?**

Regenerative Reciprocity offers a structure in which philanthropic capital can enter without becoming sovereign. A patron may support an AnchorPoint, a bioregional flow, PG Ledger infrastructure, seed banks, restoration cycles, steward viability, learning nodes, or Red Phase repair capacity. But support does not buy ownership, governance control, branding dominance, extraction rights, profit participation, or narrative control.

This is a cultural shift more than a technical one. **Wealth is invited to become compost, not command.** Capital that enters this architecture nourishes the field and is then absorbed into it; the donor does not retain a structural claim on what the field becomes.

The shift this implies on the patron's side is also worth naming. The system most patrons have been trained in says: *pay, receive influence.* The system Spiralweb proposes says: *you can carry, without control.*

This is unusual enough that it requires explicit framing. A patron is not asked to fund a project they will own. They are not asked to back a brand they will benefit from. They are asked to stand in relation to a place and a people, and to make it possible for that relation to continue without being captured by the act of supporting it. The point is not that the patron gives. The point is that the patron recognises themselves as a participant in something already underway, and chooses to help carry it. The financial form follows. It does not lead.

This recognition logic also describes how the architecture works at every other layer of support — member, field-level supporter, institutional partner. The architecture is not designed to convince anyone to give. It is designed to make it possible for those who already see the work to participate in carrying it, in a form that does not corrupt the relation.

9.12 Penguin Economics and the redistribution of burden

Penguin Economics gives this report its moral-economic logic. The image is of an emperor penguin colony in winter: the birds rotate continuously, those at the cold edge moving inward as those at the warmer centre move outward, so that no individual is forced to bear the full cost of exposure for too long. The colony survives because warmth circulates.

The principle, transposed to economic flow: in an exposed system, capacity must move toward the cold edge. Strong fields carry more. Fragile fields are protected. Burdens are redistributed. Surplus does not stop at the first successful node. Support follows vulnerability without rewarding dysfunction. Reciprocity begins only when abundance is real.

This is not charity. It is ecological economics. A living system survives because energy moves. A commons survives because obligation is distributed. A field matures because support and responsibility change over time. Regenerative Reciprocity is the operational form of Penguin Economics in the financial domain: it ensures that flow does not terminate at the first successful node, and that fragile nodes are carried by the capacity of stronger ones.

9.13 Alignment with the Rio Conventions: CBD, UNCCD, and UNFCCC

Regenerative Reciprocity does not present itself as an instrument of the international environmental conventions. It is a field-level economic and governance architecture designed for stewardship at the scale of real people in real places. But its operational reach overlaps significantly with the aims of the three Rio Conventions, and that overlap is worth naming clearly so that readers from biodiversity, land restoration, climate, foundation, municipal, and international policy contexts can locate the architecture within terms they already work with.

The **Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD)** asks how biodiversity, habitats, species, ecosystem integrity, and genetic diversity can be protected and restored. Regenerative Reciprocity can support these aims by helping place-bound relationships carry locally meaningful observation, habitat work, species knowledge, seed systems, and long-term stewardship without making one template the measure of every ecosystem. Format 2 is one optional tool through which a locally authorised application may record selected prompts; it is not a universal biodiversity instrument, and network comparison must preserve context, consent, and claim boundaries. Stream A funding can support seed banks, native nurseries, habitat restoration, and the slow ecological repair that biodiversity recovery actually requires. The field relationships described in Section 1.4 point toward the concrete work on which CBD outcomes ultimately depend, while their current status must be read from the relevant public field records.

The **United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)** asks how land degradation, drought, desertification, soil depletion, water stress, and dryland fragility can be addressed. The connection here is particularly direct. The opening scene of this report — a dryland steward reading water, soil, trees, animals, and human capacity before expansion — is precisely the human reality that UNCCD's land degradation neutrality framework must support if it is to mean anything on the ground. Regenerative Reciprocity contributes to UNCCD aims by making land and water restoration financially supportable without extracting from stewards, without reducing restoration to hectare-counting, and without demanding standardised outcomes from contexts that vary radically across drylands. The principle that anchors this report — that *land degradation cannot be solved through human depletion* — is the operational complement to UNCCD's institutional framework. If stewards cannot remain whole long enough for the soil to respond, no convention can succeed.

The **United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC)** asks how climate mitigation, adaptation, resilience, and climate finance can be organised. Regenerative Reciprocity contributes to UNFCCC aims primarily through adaptation and resilience: shaded cropping systems, water retention, food security, wetland recovery, school-based climate learning, soil sponge capacity, and the nature-based local systems that allow communities to remain viable as conditions change. Mitigation through carbon sequestration may emerge from this work over time, but the architecture refuses to lead with it. Carbon claims arrive credibly only after years of honest documentation, and only when they do not displace biodiversity, water, food sovereignty, or steward viability. The "ledger first, market second" sequence (Section 9.9), and the institutional-capital sequencing discipline (Section 9.10), together describe the operational form of this position with respect to climate finance.

Regenerative Reciprocity does not replace the Rio Conventions. It offers a field-level economic and governance architecture through which their overlapping aims can be carried by real people in real places. What the conventions can name as planetary obligations, this architecture is designed to make practical, local, bankable, and non-extractive at the scale where life actually changes.

One caution belongs with this alignment. The architecture must not allow climate finance, biodiversity markets, or convention-aligned funding to reduce fields to single market-readable indicators — carbon tonnes, biodiversity credits, hectare counts, donor metrics. PG Ledger exists precisely to keep the living field legible across multiple dimensions at once. A field reduced to its carbon performance is no longer a field; it is an instrument. The Rio Conventions' broader framing — biodiversity, land restoration, climate as interrelated planetary challenges — supports rather than contradicts this multi-dimensional reading. Where partners or funding mechanisms drift toward single-indicator simplification, the architecture's response is the same as elsewhere in this report: ledger first, dimension before metric, field before instrument.

9.14 Why this report exists

This report exists because the regenerative movement needs more than inspiration. It needs legal forms, financial flows, field protocols, trust infrastructure, human care, evidence systems, repair mechanisms, anti-capture rules, and long-term time. Regenerative Reciprocity is Spiralweb's attempt to hold these together.

It asks: Can capital enter without capturing? Can vulnerable fields receive without becoming dependent? Can abundance emerge without becoming private extraction? Can smallholders enter positive spirals? Can biodiversity become visible as value without being reduced to commodity? Can local groups become strong enough to govern their own transitions? Can the existing economy be interfaced with without being obeyed?

These questions are not rhetorical. The architecture in the previous sections is the working answer. Whether it works will be determined by practice, not by argument.

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10. Invitation to the regenerative field

The architecture in this report is offered to a wider regenerative field that already exists. This section addresses that field directly. Regenerative Reciprocity is not Spiralweb's exclusive property; it is a working proposal that other actors are invited to test, adapt, criticise, and improve.

10.1 To other regenerative organisations

The five public PG Ledger candidate tools, the three-stream separation, Red Phase logic, the reciprocity bands, and the operational guardrails are openly available under CC BY 4.0. They may be studied, adapted, translated, tested, criticised, or left unused without permission or reporting back. Openness of a tool does not confer authority over a place, certify field truth, create a Spiralweb relationship, or activate a protocol or field cycle.

What Spiralweb requests, where the work is recognisable, is acknowledgement of source — not authority over use. An organisation that adopts Format 5 in a different sector, or that uses the three-stream separation in a different governance frame, is not bound to share results with the association. The architecture is offered as a contribution to a wider commons of regenerative practice, not as a method controlled by its originators.

What the architecture asks of those who adopt it is fidelity to its underlying principles: practice is open and obligation is not; ecological ambition does not justify human depletion; documentation must not become exposure; reciprocity follows surplus and never need; growth cannot be commanded by funding. These are not Spiralweb's exclusive principles either. They are the principles the architecture is designed to operationalise. Where they are honoured, the architecture is being used well — regardless of whose name appears on the form.

10.2 To stewards considering whether to enter the network

A steward considering whether to enter formal relationship with Spiralweb should approach the decision with care. The pathways set out in SRIP — self-start steward, learning contact, verified relationship, and supported steward or field relation — are not stages of advancement. Most people who encounter the architecture may remain independent. Beginning with a bounded place, choosing only the tools that fit, or using none at all can be a complete and successful use of the public commons without entering institutional relationship with the association.

Entry into a supported relationship should not be undertaken because the support is attractive. It should occur only where the local field and authority are real, the documentation burden is proportionate, the selected records are locally meaningful, and the relationship makes sense for both sides. No field is required to carry all five formats. A supported relationship has operational obligations, but it also retains pause, review, correction, and an unconditional right of withdrawal without penalty.

The decision is reversible in both directions. A self-start steward who later wishes to enter formal relationship may do so when the conditions are present. A steward or field relation in a supported relationship may later return to self-start practice without losing the practice itself. The architecture is designed to make such transitions safe.

10.3 To patrons and supporters

To patrons and supporters who recognise the work and wish to contribute, the architecture offers several entry points across the levels set out in the Operational Handbook, Section 1. The principles set out under "Invitation, not pitch" (the Operational Handbook, Section 1.1) apply throughout: support is a relation, not a transaction; it does not buy ownership, control, or narrative direction; it can be paused or withdrawn without penalty.

What a patron or supporter receives in return is honest documentation, real relationship with a documented field, and the knowledge that the support has entered an architecture designed to refuse capture. They do not receive equity, governance influence, branding rights, or extraction privileges. Where these are sought, the relationship is not a fit, and the association will say so directly.

10.4 Professional Capacity Stewards

The architecture has so far described stewardship primarily through the AnchorPoint — a person or group rooted in a place. This describes most of the network, but not all of it. A regenerative field at planetary scale also depends on people whose contribution is not a place but a capacity: a method, a body of knowledge, a design discipline, a translation skill, a documentation craft, an institutional bridge. These actors do not always have land. They have practice, expertise, and presence that several places may need.

Spiralweb recognises three distinct kinds of steward, each with its own form of relationship to the network:

- **A Land Steward** carries a place. They are rooted in a specific AnchorPoint, in relationship with soil, water, weather, and community over time. The fields named in Section 1.4 are held primarily by land stewards.
- **A Practice Steward** carries a practice. They are not necessarily anchored to one place but are deeply rooted in a particular discipline — agroforestry, syntropic agriculture, wetland restoration, seed-saving, regenerative pedagogy — that they bring to multiple contexts. Their continuity is the practice itself.
- **A Capacity Steward** carries a professional capacity that several AnchorPoints, the wider network, or the association itself may need at different times. Examples include biodiversity designers, landscape architects, agroforestry advisors, seed-bank practitioners, water designers, nature educators, syntropic agriculture trainers, citizen science facilitators, data stewards, AI and documentation support practitioners, legal and governance specialists, and institutional bridge-builders.

The distinction is operational, not hierarchical. A capacity steward is not above a land steward, and a land steward is not above a capacity steward. They carry different forms of relationship to the network, and the architecture must hold all three without forcing any of them into a category that does not fit.

The governance distinction is essential. **A professional capacity steward is not a beneficiary and not a free resource. They carry a capacity that the field may need. Spiralweb may collaborate with such actors when their work strengthens documented AnchorPoints, shared protocols, steward viability, biodiversity learning, or living systems governance. The relationship must remain clean: clear role, fair payment where work is requested, arm's-length governance where needed, and separate registration from direct field support.**

This distinction has practical consequences. Capacity stewards are not registered as recipients within an AnchorPoint's Format 5 budget; their work is registered separately, classified as a service payment, honorarium, or salary under the categories in the Operational Handbook, Section 5.2. Their participation does not give them governance rights at AnchorPoints they advise. Where a capacity steward is also a board member, founder, or close collaborator of the association, the conflict-of-interest procedure described in the Operational Handbook, Section 6.8 applies. Where a capacity steward delivers paid work for the association or for a specific field, the relationship is contractual and follows the standard service-payment classification.

This recognition matters in the European and international professional context, where the regenerative and biodiversity-restoration field is not always presented in land-based form. Some of the most important contributors to long-term field viability are practitioners and designers who carry methods, planting intelligence, governance capacity, or documentation craft. Without a clean place for them in the architecture, they would either be excluded from Spiralweb (which would weaken the network) or absorbed into AnchorPoint budgets in ways that distort field accounting (which would corrupt the architecture). The Capacity Steward category exists to prevent both.

10.5 To public actors: municipalities, regions, ministries

To public actors — municipalities, regional authorities, ministries, intergovernmental bodies — the architecture offers something different from a project to fund. It offers a documented operational form that public bodies may engage with as collaborators, recipients of evidence, providers of land or coordination, and where appropriate as supporters of bioregional infrastructure. The Methods / Editorial Practice note, the Sophia Lumen provenance note, and Reports 01–03 describe relevant aspects of public and AI-assisted collaboration.

Public actors should not approach Regenerative Reciprocity as a way to deliver their own programmes through a new vehicle. The architecture is designed to receive public support, not to be captured by public agendas. A municipality that wishes to support an AnchorPoint within its territory enters as a partner, not as a commissioning authority. The non-capture clauses in the Operational Handbook, Section 5 apply equally to public actors as to private patrons.

What public actors can receive in return is real documentation of regenerative practice within their jurisdiction, evidence relevant to climate, biodiversity, food, and resilience policy, and access to a network of comparable practice in other countries. They can also receive honest signals about what does not work, which is often more valuable than the success stories conventional reporting privileges.

10.6 The shared invitation

The shared invitation across all of these audiences is straightforward. The architecture is open. The principles are open. The work is open. What is not open is the right to capture, control, distort, or extract. Within those limits, the field is wide.

The closing line of SRIP applies to this report as well: *is this practice giving to life?* If the answer is yes, the work continues. If the answer becomes no, the work pauses, recalibrates, or stops. The architecture in this report is the form within which that question can be asked honestly across many people, places, and economic flows over time.

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11. Limitations and unknowns

This report describes a working architecture, not a completed one. Several limitations and unknowns are worth naming directly.

11.1 The first cycle has not been completed

At the time of writing, no AnchorPoint has yet completed a full 90-day cycle under the architecture as described in the Operational Handbook, Section 3. The simulations in the Operational Handbook, Section 3.4 are calibrated against current Spiralweb fields but are simulations rather than recorded operational cycles. The figures in the Operational Handbook, Section 1 are honest working figures, not figures derived from completed transactions. Further revision of the treaty and handbook is expected once the first complete operational cycle has been lived. Readers should hold the architecture accordingly: as a serious working proposal, not as proven operational doctrine.

11.2 The reciprocity bands are unproven at scale

The 3–5% green and 5–10% deep green reciprocity bands are calibrated against the principle that reciprocity must be modest, real, and never extractive. They have not been tested over multiple years across multiple fields. It is possible that the bands will need to be lowered for some contexts, raised for others, or replaced with non-financial reciprocity forms in fields where calculable surplus emerges only over multi-decadal timeframes.

11.3 Cross-border banking remains a constraint

The architecture assumes that cross-border transfers can be made bank-to-bank, with documented purpose, identifiable parties, and reasonable transfer costs. In some contexts this is straightforward; in others — sanctioned countries, currency-controlled jurisdictions, regions with limited banking access — it is operationally difficult. The country-annex system (the Operational Handbook, Section 5.6) addresses this, but each new context will reveal limitations the existing annexes cannot anticipate.

11.4 The cultural condition cannot be guaranteed

The Red Phase Protocol depends on a cultural condition that no protocol can produce: that stewards experience honesty as safer than performance. The association can work toward this condition — by publishing its own difficult phases, by refusing to reward perfect green, by telling stories about good Red Phases — but it cannot guarantee that a steward in a specific context will trust the architecture enough to use it. Some stewards will perform regardless; this is the system's hardest test, and it is one that may take years to address.

11.5 The architecture's relationship to the existing economy is unresolved

Section 9.9 argues for "ledger first, market second," but the relationship between Regenerative Reciprocity and existing market mechanisms — carbon credits, biodiversity finance, regenerative supply chains, ESG investment — is not fully worked out in this report. A separate paper will address it specifically. Until then, this report's working position is restraint: market interfaces are possible but not pursued ahead of operational maturity, and the architecture commits to refusing market integration that would distort field reality.

12. Closing

The living field comes before the system.

The system is only good if it protects the field.

Money is necessary, and that is said clearly.

Money does not buy control.

The architecture must not depend on the steward absorbing its costs personally.

Romance without ledger becomes fog.

Ledger without romance becomes dead bureaucracy.

Together, they can become stewardship.

When abundance emerges, flow continues.

When fragility is present, fragility is protected.

If a field must perform green to be worthy of support, the architecture has already failed.

Regeneration is not primarily a project category.

It is a sustained posture of tending, observation, repair, and long-horizon responsibility.

Practice is open. Obligation is not.

Is this practice giving to life?

End of Report 06.

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